

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	18th June 2026
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Project Name	ShopEZ – E-Commerce Application Using Mern Stack
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

WHO are we empathizing with?

User 1 – Online Shopper (Priya, 24 years old)

Priya is a working professional who prefers shopping online during her free time. She uses her mobile phone and laptop to browse products. She wants a platform that is fast, easy to use, and secure. She has faced bad experiences with complicated checkout processes and unclear product information in the past.

User 2 – Admin / Store Manager (Ravi, 35 years old)

Ravi owns a small online business and manages product listings, customer orders, and inventory. He does not have a technical background and needs a simple but powerful dashboard to run his store. He struggles with tracking orders manually and has no way to see which products are selling well.

What do they THINK & FEEL?

Online Shopper – Priya:

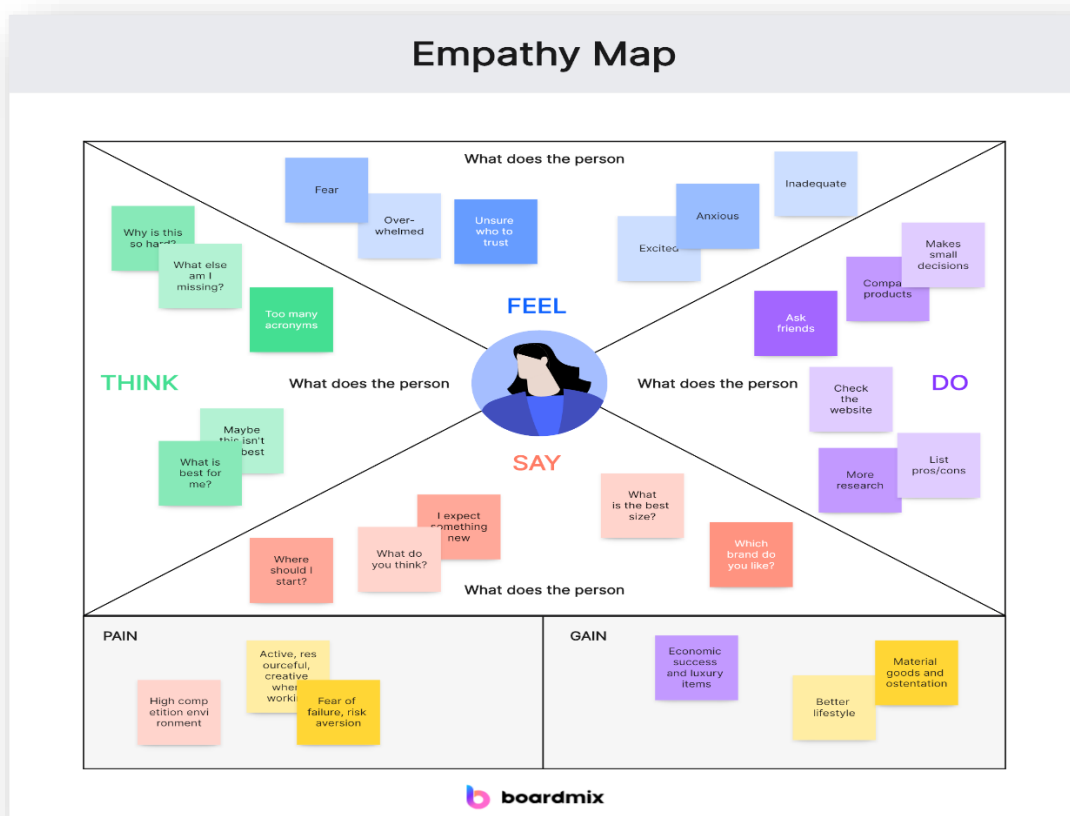
- Thinks that online shopping should be as simple as walking into a store and picking up what she wants
- Feels frustrated when product pages take too long to load or have missing information like price, size, or availability
- Feels nervous about entering her bank or card details on platforms that do not look secure
- Feels happy and satisfied when she gets an instant order confirmation with clear details
- Worries about receiving the wrong product or not being able to track her order after placing it

- Feels excited when she finds a product at a good discount with positive customer reviews

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- Thinks that managing an online store should not require technical knowledge or multiple tools
- Feels overwhelmed when customer orders pile up and he has no clear way to manage them
- Feels stressed when he cannot figure out which products need to be restocked
- Feels confident and motivated when he can see clear sales data and business growth reports
- Worries about making mistakes while updating product listings manually
- Feels proud when his store runs smoothly and customers are happy with their orders

Example:



What do they SEE?

Online Shopper – Priya:

- Multiple e-commerce platforms like Amazon and Flipkart that are feature-heavy and sometimes overwhelming
- Product pages with poor quality images, missing descriptions, and no customer reviews
- Long and complicated checkout forms asking for too much information at once
- Other people around her shopping online easily and getting quick deliveries
- Advertisements for new products and discounts on social media that redirect to confusing websites
- Friends using simple shopping apps on their phones and having a smooth experience

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- Other sellers using advanced platforms with built-in dashboards and analytics
- His own store data scattered across spreadsheets, emails, and manual records
- Customers complaining on social media about delayed orders or wrong products
- Competitors growing their business faster using better e-commerce management tools
- No proper system showing him which categories or products are performing well
- A growing need for a single platform that handles everything from product listing to order delivery

What do they SAY?

Online Shopper – Priya:

- "I just want to find my product, add it to cart, and buy it in two minutes"
- "Why do I have to fill in so many details just to place one order?"
- "I am not sure if my order was placed — there was no proper confirmation"
- "The product looked different in the picture compared to what I received"
- "I would shop here more often if the checkout was simpler and faster"
- "I always check reviews before buying — but this platform has none"

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- "I need one single place where I can see all my products and orders together"

- "How do I know which products are selling and which are not?"
- "Every time I want to update a product, it takes so many steps"
- "I have no idea how my business is performing this month compared to last month"
- "I wish I could just add a product quickly with a picture, price, and description"
- "Customers keep asking about their order status but I have no proper tracking system"

What do they DO?

Online Shopper – Priya:

- Opens multiple tabs to compare the same product on different platforms before buying
- Reads all available customer reviews and checks product ratings carefully
- Abandons the cart when the checkout process is too long or asks for too much information
- Searches for discount codes before completing a purchase
- Checks her email and profile page repeatedly to confirm whether her order was placed
- Contacts customer support when she does not receive order confirmation or delivery updates
- Shares her shopping experience on social media — good or bad

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- Manually writes down orders in a notebook or spreadsheet every day
- Updates product listings one by one which takes a lot of time and effort
- Sends individual messages to customers to confirm their orders
- Tries to calculate monthly sales manually without any analytics tool
- Spends extra time fixing errors caused by managing products without a proper system
- Looks for affordable and easy-to-use e-commerce platforms that do not require coding

Online Shopper – Priya:

- Product catalog is disorganized and hard to browse through
- No proper search or filter option to find the right product quickly
- Checkout process is long, confusing, and not mobile-friendly
- No instant order confirmation after placing an order

PAINS

- Fear of payment data being stolen or misused
- Cannot easily track order status or view purchase history
- Poor or missing customer reviews make it hard to make decisions

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- No centralized dashboard to manage products, orders, and categories together
- No analytics or reporting tool to understand business performance
- Product listing and updating process is slow and complicated
- No role-based access system to separate admin and user permissions
- Manual order tracking leads to errors and customer dissatisfaction
- No banner or category management to organize the store visually
- Difficult to scale the business without proper data and tools.

GAINS

Online Shopper – Priya:

- Clean and simple product catalog with clear descriptions, images, pricing, and reviews
- Easy "Shop Now" button that directly takes her to order details without confusion
- Secure and fast checkout process with minimal steps
- Instant order confirmation with complete details including shipping and payment
- Ability to view order history and track current orders from the profile section
- JWT-based secure login that protects her personal and payment information
- Mobile-friendly interface that works smoothly on any device

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- Centralized admin dashboard with complete control over products, orders, and categories
- Recharts-powered analytics to visualize sales trends and business performance
- Easy product management — add, update, delete listings in a few clicks
- Banner image management to keep the store visually attractive and organized
- Role-based access control to ensure only admins can access sensitive data
- Real-time order tracking and management to reduce errors and improve customer satisfaction
- A scalable MERN stack platform that can grow with the business needs.

What do they HEAR?

Online Shopper – Priya:

- Friends and family recommending faster and simpler shopping apps
- Online reviews saying that certain platforms have poor customer support
- News and articles about online payment fraud and personal data breaches
- Influencers on social media promoting new products and online shopping deals
- Colleagues talking about getting wrong or damaged products from online stores
- Feedback from her own experience about platforms that are slow and hard to use

Admin / Seller – Ravi:

- Customers calling and complaining about delayed deliveries and wrong orders
- Other sellers talking about how easy it is to manage their store on better platforms
- Business advisors saying that data and analytics are essential for business growth
- Employees pointing out how much time is wasted on manual order tracking
- Feedback from customers saying product descriptions and images are unclear
- Industry news about the growing importance of having a strong online presence